

AGENTS AND COMPLEXITY

Every mistake added a rule

A friend's agent verification kept breaking. The code held up. The process around it did not.

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concurrency attacks, no failures

The tool under verification is fine. What keeps breaking is the machinery around it.

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Every mistake added a rule, and every new rule caused new mistakes.

THE FRIEND, IN THEIR OWN WORDS

Six patterns that kept failing

Compaction skips mandatory steps

Failing commands lose their output

100 KB prompts recited from memory

Scripts edited in place

Harness suggests what rules forbid

Rules breeding rules

Complexity is a position on a map

Custom-built process sitting where commodities already exist, while files, hashes and git sit unused.

Answer a mistake with a component, not a rule

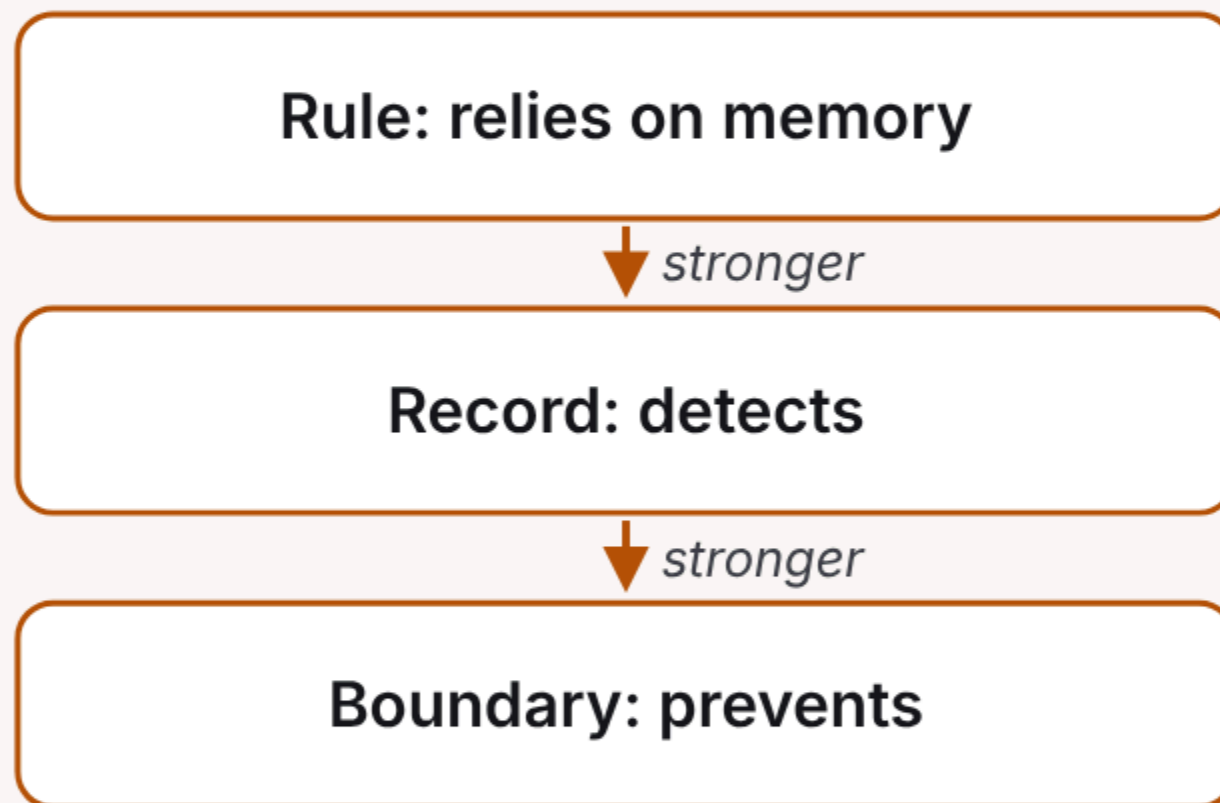
Add a rule

- The prompt grows
- The session compacts sooner
- Compaction picks which rules survive

Ship a component

- The mistake stops being possible
- The rule can go

When a rule fails, use a stronger barrier



Rules for incidents, machines for enforcement.

Where to start

- 1 Map it and mark the custom-built blob
- 2 Cut the prompt to a page
- 3 Commit before you run
- 4 Harm stops, form is logged
- 5 Delete rules a component makes unnecessary

Make the process small and boring

Spend the rigour on the tool. If you are not getting faster, complexity is winning.

sgit.ai/articles/every-mistake-added-a-rule.html